Alida Ngwengang Angafor

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EDUCATION

M.A., Philosophy · Central European University, Vienna, Austria · 2024–2026

- Thesis: "Understanding the First-Person Viewpoint from the Third: Some Remarks on Being Someone." Supervisor: Lisa Doerksen.
- Argues that the subjectivity of phenomenal consciousness, the fact that every experience is for someone, is grounded in a persisting subject rather than a self constituted only within momentary experience.
- Graduate coursework: Laws of Nature (Ferenc Huoranszki); Objectivity (Maria Kronfeldner); Advanced Epistemology and Beliefs and Desires (Katalin Farkas); Epistemology (Phyllis Pearson); Ethics (Simon Rippon).

B.A., Philosophy and Sociology, Minor in Astronomy · Dartmouth College, Hanover, NH · 2017–2021

- Capstone project: *Knowledge Through Imagination*, supervised by Peter Lewis.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Areas of specialization: Philosophy of cosmology, philosophy of time, philosophy of mind

Areas of competence: Epistemology (self-locating belief), metaphysics of the self, philosophy of artificial intelligence

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Where Do We Go Between Experiences? Existential Subjectivity and the Self in Experience" · Article in preparation, drawn from M.A. thesis

- Distinguishes existential subjectivity, the persisting subject that experience depends on, from experiential subjectivity, the self as it shows up within experience, and argues that a subject cannot be just its conscious experiences.

"Misalignment as Evidence of Human Error, Not Machine Agency" · Article in preparation

- Argues that attributing agency to AI systems, including calling their outputs deceptive rather than erroneous, rests on Dennett's intentional stance, and that misalignment reflects the designers' error rather than machine agency. Includes a companion experimental protocol testing perspective invariance and goal ownership in language models.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Brad Skow · Department of Linguistics and Philosophy, MIT · Jan–Mar 2021

- Collected and summarized, with peers, articles on the scientific understanding of cause and effect from a philosophical perspective, and gave weekly presentations on the week's progress.

Research Assistant to Prof. Maron Greenleaf · Department of Anthropology, Dartmouth College · Jan–May 2021

- Researched the relation between development and inclusion, and compiled a historical literature review on inclusion and exclusion in development.

Human Development Research Fellow · John Sloan Dickey Center for International Understanding, Dartmouth College · 2018–2021

- Completed six terms of paid research assistantships on faculty-led, field-based projects aimed at alleviating poverty in low-income countries.

Research and Policy Intern · Latin America Youth Center, Washington, DC · 2014–2015

- Designed and administered surveys on adolescent drug use, and wrote policy recommendations based on the results.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Astronomy Teaching Assistant · Appalachian Mountain Club (Mt of Stars), Bretton Woods, NH · Jun–Aug 2019

- Hiked from hut to hut across the White Mountains, giving public astronomy lectures, leading night observing sessions, and running programs to introduce children to astronomy.

Teaching Assistant · Dartmouth Leadership Attitudes and Behaviors Program · Jan–Apr 2019

- Facilitated conversations about the identities and experiences that shape each person's values and practice of leadership.

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- Human Development Fellowship, John Sloan Dickey Center for International Understanding, Dartmouth College, 2018–2021
- Central European University Master's Scholarship (tuition and stipend), 2024–2026
- Abramson Foundation Scholarship, 2017–2021
- Future Business Leaders of America Scholarship, 2017–2021
- PLATO Grant for Philosophy Programs, 2017. Funded a philosophy essay competition I organized for my high school peers.

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

- CS 2881R: AI Safety, Harvard University (Prof. Boaz Barak), external participant, Fall 2026

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Therapist Understudy · Nashoba Learning Group, Massachusetts · Sep 2026–present

- Deliver one-to-one instruction based on applied behavior analysis to students with autism, collecting behavioral and skills data to track their progress.

Child Welfare Caseworker · Chaffee County Department of Human Services, Salida, CO · Nov 2023–Aug 2024

- Investigated allegations of child abuse and neglect, conducting assessments with families to determine whether a child needed to be placed outside the home, often from evidence that was incomplete and still unfolding.
- Developed case plans with families and testified in court on ongoing cases and shelter hearings.

Crew Leader · SouthWest Conservation Corps · Mar–Nov 2023

- Led and trained conservation field crews on technical projects through ten-hour workdays, coordinating logistics with project partners and staff.

Field Guide · Pacific Quest Horticultural Therapy Program, Hilo, HI · Feb–Aug 2022

- Built rapport with students while holding the boundaries that furthered their therapeutic outcomes, in close collaboration with the treatment team.

Field Mentor · Elements Wilderness Therapy, Huntington, UT · Aug 2021–Feb 2022

- Supported students through eight-day field shifts, responsible for their physical and emotional safety and working with their therapists to carry out weekly treatment plans.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Minorities and Philosophy (MAP), Central European University chapter, 2024–present
- Central European University Philosophy Club, 2024–present
- Dartmouth College Philosophy Club, 2018–2021

SKILLS

Languages: English (native), Spanish (conversational), German (elementary) · **Programming:** Python, C++, HTML, CSS

REFERENCES

Available upon request